

# Post-incident review PIR-2025-049

## Payments API: partial outage

*Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.*

### Summary

On 06 May 2025, Payments API experienced partial outage in production (AU East) for about 160 minutes. A partner raised a case with the service desk before any internal signal fired. Investigation found that request volume during a marketing campaign exceeded the provisioned throughput.

### Impact

Users of Payments API saw partial outage for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Payments Platform, led the response.

### Timeline

- 09:15 First signal received.
- 09:33 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:52 Likely cause identified.
- 10:05 Mitigation applied.
- 10:46 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

### What happened

Investigation found that request volume during a marketing campaign exceeded the provisioned throughput.

The team first suspected a recent configuration change, but the change log showed nothing relevant.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

### What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

### Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.